

Cold Call Phone Script

AgriProve — Riverina Field Research Program

Pure cold call — no prior contact — data scrape list. Primary close: farm visit with Hobbs. Secondary close: HORIZON Snapshot.

Part 1 — Opening Lines

Choose one opener based on your read of the prospect. All keep AgriProve out of the first sentence. Reason for calling is in sentence two or three — not after a warm-up.

OPTION 1 — RESEARCHER FRAME

BEN

G'day [name], it's Ben here — I'm assisting an ag researcher out of Albury who's running a field research program across the Riverina. He's visiting farms in the area and I thought your place might be worth including. Is that something you'd be open to?

Clean and non-threatening. Works best when you want to get Hobbs to the door before soil carbon comes up at all.

OPTION 2 — ASSESSMENT FRAME

BEN

G'day [name], Ben here — I'm conducting an assessment of farming operations across the Riverina as part of an outreach program based out of Albury. Your property came up and I wanted to reach out directly. Have I caught you at an okay time?

"Your property came up" creates mild curiosity without being misleading. Works well when you have some basic property data from the scrape.

OPTION 3 — GRAZIER-FIRST FRAME (RECOMMENDED FOR LARGER OPERATIONS)

BEN

G'day [name], it's Ben — I'll keep it quick. I'm coordinating farm visits for an ag researcher from the US who's based in Albury for a few months. He's a grazier himself, written books on grazing management, and he's been visiting operations across the Riverina. I thought your place was worth a look — is that something you'd be open to?

Puts Hobbs front and centre from word one. Best for experienced graziers where the credentials do the heavy lifting.

OPTION 4 — CURIOSITY FRAME

BEN

G'day Ben here. We're running a regional program out of Albury looking at what's working across Riverina grazing operations — specifically the ones generating strong results. Your place came up. I'm not going to take up much of your time — I just wanted to see if you'd be open to a farm visit.

Paddock conversation or Fence-line chat Practical grazing session

We're researching ways that help our current partners/clients grow more grass/get better results. (We assume that if they're growing more grass/getting better results, they're creating more soil carbon.)

"Specifically the ones generating strong results" is a soft compliment that positions them as selected, not randomly dialled.

OPTION 5 — STRIPPED BACK (FOR VERY TIME-POOR FARMERS)

BEN

G'day [name], Ben here. I'm coordinating farm visits for an ag researcher based in Albury — he's spending a few months looking at operations across the Riverina. Would you be open to having him come out?

Nothing wasted. Straight to yes/no in under 15 seconds.

Part 2 — Secondary Response

Once they're still on the line and want to know more, transition into this. Keep it conversational — not a rehearsed pitch.

EXPAND ON THE PROGRAM

BEN

Our company is running an assessment of the Albury/Riverina region through an outreach field research program — essentially looking for innovative producers who are doing cool things and generating results. I'm wondering if you'd be open-minded to host a short visit to see what's working for you.

WHEN THEY ASK "WHO IS YOUR COMPANY?"

FARMER

Who is your company?

BEN

I'm with a company called AgriProve. We're researching ways to help our current partners and clients grow more grass and get better results. We've found that if a producer is growing more grass and getting better results, they're generally creating more soil carbon — that's the connection.

WHEN THEY ASK "YOU'RE NOT GOING TO TRY TO SELL ME SOMETHING, ARE YOU?"

FARMER

You're not going to try to sell me something, are you?

BEN

No — we're looking for ways to help the clients we're already working with have greater success. And I'd assume that if you wanted to be part of a soil carbon project, you probably would have already looked into it. This is just a genuine knowledge-sharing visit.

Honesty about the soil carbon connection builds more trust than evasion. If they push further, be straight: "We do work in soil carbon — I won't pretend it's completely unrelated — but the visit itself isn't a pitch."

Part 3 — Common Objections

"WE LOOKED AT CARBON A FEW YEARS AGO AND IT DIDN'T STACK UP"

FARMER

We looked at carbon a few years ago and it didn't stack up.

BEN

Yeah, fair call — the early programs were pretty rough. The ACCU price was twelve, thirteen dollars back then and the methodology was a lot clunkier. The spot price is sitting around \$35 now and the framework's matured significantly. I'm not saying it's right for everyone, but it's worth a fresh look.

"WE'RE PROBABLY TOO SMALL"

FARMER

We're only about 200 ha — probably too small.

BEN

The threshold used to be higher — around 300 to 400 was where we'd draw the line. We've become a lot more flexible. Smallest project I've got running is around 160 ha. We'd run a quick desktop assessment first to see what's actually eligible on your place — no cost, takes a couple of days.

"NOT INTERESTED RIGHT NOW"

FARMER

Not really interested at the moment.

BEN

No worries at all — is it alright if I touch base in a few months when things settle down a bit?

A soft door-leave costs nothing and keeps the lead alive. Never a hard hang-up.

Part 4 — Closing the Visit

As soon as there's a yes signal — close immediately. Don't narrate more of the offer.

CLOSE WITH TWO SPECIFIC OPTIONS

BEN

Good stuff. He's flexible — are you around Monday or Wednesday afternoon next week? I'll send his number through as well so you've got it if anything changes.

Two specific options closes visits. Open-ended availability ("are you free sometime?") produces open-ended outcomes.

IF THEY WANT NUMBERS BEFORE COMMITTING TO A VISIT

FARMER

What sort of returns would we even be looking at?

BEN

Hard to give you a real number without looking at your country first. What we can do is run a free desktop soil carbon report — takes a couple of days, no obligation. It uses satellite data and about 20,000 soil data points from live projects across Australia. Shows your carbon potential and what we'd exclude. All I need is your lot and plan numbers — they're on your rates notice.

The HORIZON Snapshot converts skeptical farmers. Offer it as a standalone next step — don't ask for a Snapshot and a visit in the same breath.

Hard Rules

- No company name in the first sentence. Earn the conversation first.
- Reason for calling is in sentence two or three — not after a warm-up. Farmers are straight to the point.
- Be honest about the soil carbon connection when asked directly. Evasion kills trust faster than the product does.
- Close with two specific days. Open-ended availability produces open-ended outcomes.
- Don't offer the Snapshot and a visit in the same breath. One ask at a time.
- Soft door-leave on every no — “Is it alright if I touch base in a few months?”